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Lesson 20 Snake poison

蛇毒 虚拟语气 主语从句

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saliva / səˈlaɪvə /
defy / dɪˈfaɪ /
prey / preɪ /
tussle / ˈtʌs(ə)l /
vertebrate / ˈvɜːtɪbrət /
concoct / kənˈkɒkt /
conversion / kənˈvɜːʃ(ə)n /
strychnine / ˈstrɪkniːn /
cobra / ˈkəʊbrə /
neurotoxic / ˌnjʊərəʊˈtɒksɪk /
adder / ˈædə(r) /
haemolytic / ˌhiːməʊˈlɪtɪk /
digestive / daɪˈdʒestɪv /
analysis / əˈnæləsɪs /
fierce / fɪəs /
carnivore / ˈkɑːnɪvɔː(r) /
lizard / ˈlɪzəd /
potency / ˈpəʊt(ə)nsi /
arsenic / ˈɑːsnɪk /
mamba / ˈmæmbə /
venom / ˈvenəm /
viper / ˈvaɪpə(r) /
rattlesnake / ˈrætlsneɪk /
viperine / ˈvaɪpəˌraɪn /

引出 (笔记最后修改于:2025-12-08 07:05:07)

※ How it came about that snakes manufactured poison is a mystery. 主语从句 套主语从句

『**come about** to happen, especially in a way that is not planned （意外地事情）发生』

- Can you tell me how the accident **came about**?
- How did it **come about** that he knew where we were?
- That **came about** when we went to New York last year. 那件事发生在去年我们去纽约时。

『**manufacture** (technical) if your body manufactures a particular useful substance, it produces it （身体）产生，制造，分泌』

- Vitamins cannot be **manufactured by our bodies**.
- Diabetics don't **manufacture enough insulin**.
- It may have been **manufactured** hours or days ago in your lungs. 它可能是几个小时前或几天前在你的肺里制造的。

『 **How it came about that ... is a mystery.** 某个事情怎么发生的，是个谜 』

- **How it came about that** Maya civilization vanished from the earth **is a mystery.** 玛雅文明是如何突然从地球上消失的，是一个谜
- **It has never been explained why** Maya civilization vanished from the earth.
- **It has never been explained why** snakes manufactured poison. 课文写法替换

It has never been explained why ... 谁也无法解释...	**It has never been explained why** Maya civilization vanished from the earth.

※ Over the periods their saliva, a mild, digestive juice like our own, was converted into a poison that defies analysis even today.

『 **defy** be so difficult as to make (sth.) impossible 无法...;使...不可能 』

- Beauty sometimes **defies** description.
- The problem **defied** solution.
- a political move that **defies** explanation
- It's a devastating and barbaric act that **defies all comprehension**.

> The beauty of the West Lake **is more than** words **can** describe. be more than ... can / could ... 是...无法...

『 **be more than ... can / could...** 表达"是...无法..." 』

- When my old friend Brian urged me to accept a cigarette, it **was more than** I **could** bear.
- Dancing proved to **be more than** the dish **could** bear, for during the party it capsized and sank in seven feet of water.
- The pain **is more than** I can **bear**.
- The story i**s more than** I can **believe**.
- The beauty of the West Lake **is more than** words **can** describe.
- The weather turned out to be very good, which **was more than** we **could** expect.

defy description 无法描述	The beauty of the Grand Canyon **defies description**; you simply must see it for yourself. 大峡谷的美景无法描述，你必须亲自去看。
defy analysis 无法分析	The chaotic data set seemed to **defy analysis**, frustrating the research team. 这个混乱的数据集似乎无法分析，让研究团队感到沮丧。

defy belief 令人难以置信	His sudden recovery from a terminal illness **defies belief**, it's nothing short of a miracle. 他从绝症中突然康复令人难以置信，简直就是个奇迹。
defy solution 无法解决	The complex political deadlock continues to **defy solution** despite months of negotiation. 复杂的政治僵局经过数月的谈判仍无法解决。
defy explanation 无法解释	The mysterious disappearance of the ship **defies explanation**, even after extensive investigation. 这艘船神秘失踪，即使经过广泛调查也无法解释。
defy understanding/comprehension 无法理解/领会	The advanced physics theory can often **defy understanding/comprehension** for those without a specialized background. 对于没有专业背景的人来说，先进的物理理论往往无法理解/领会。
be beyond sth. 无法...；不容...	• The rumor is **beyond** belief. 这个谣言不容置信. • The car i**s beyond** repair. • The situation **is beyond** my control. • The results **are beyond** dispute / controversy. • Her beauty **is beyond** words / description. • His conduct **is beyond** reproach / criticism. • The pain **is beyond** human endurance. • Working with you **is beyond** my wildest dreams. • We might say that justice has been done when a man's innocence or guilt **has been proved beyond** doubt.

※ It was not forced upon them by the survival competition; they could have caught and lived on prey without using poison, just as the thousands of non-poisonous snakes still do.

『**force sth. on / upon sb.** 把...强加给...』

- It's no good trying to **force** a diet **on** someone.
- people who try to **force** their own views **on** you.

impose sth. on / upon sb. 把...强加给...	I don't want them to **impose** their religious beliefs **on / upon** my children.把他们的宗教信仰强加给我的孩子

exert sth. on / upon sb. 对某人施加...	• ... ,Advertising **exerts** a subtle influence **on** us. • Antique shops **exert** a peculiar fascination **on** a great many people.

『 **without using poison** 如果不使用毒液（介词短语充当条件状语） 』

- ...; they could have caught and lived on prey if they **had not used** poison, ... 替换
- **Without** it we could not make a living. ⇒ If we **didn't have** it we could not make a living.
- **Without** it, nothing could ever be brought to a conclusion; everything would be in a state of chaos. ⇒ If we **didn't have** it nothing could ever be brought to a conclusion; everything would be in state of chaos.
- There would be no living things **without** air. ⇒ There would be no living things if there **were** no air.
- **In his position**, I would have committed suicide. ⇒ If I **had been** in his position, I would have committed suicide.

『 **just as ... still do** 就像...仍然在做一样 』

- ... they could have **caught and lived on prey without using poison**, just as the thousands of non-poisonous snakes still **catch and live on prey without using poison**. 课文补全

※ Poison to a snake is merely a luxury; it enables it to get its food with very little effort, no more effort than one bite.

『 **luxury / necessity** 奢侈品 / 必需品 』

- Limousines and perfumes are **luxuries** while food, clothing, shelter and transportation are daily **necessities**.
- Mostly they climb as a **necessity** to make money. 他们大多把登山当作赚钱的必经之路。
- Few could afford the **luxury**. 很少有人买得起这种奢侈品。

『 **no more than ...** 仅仅，只不过 』

- His answer was to lift the vessel out of the water by making it ride on a cushion of air, **no more than** one or two feet thick.
- When one seriously studies the social orders that have had the opportunity to develop autonomously, the figure becomes **no more than** an exact and matter-of-fact observation.
- Modern cloth diapers are surprisingly easy to use, almost **no more** work **than** putting on a disposable.

※ And why only snakes (manufacture poison)?

- My brother likes coffee, and I **do**, too. (省略了 "like coffee")
- She is taller than her sister. (省略了 "is tall")
- He eats more than I **do**. (省略了 "eat")
- Just **waiting** (now). (省略了 "I am" 和 "now")
- On the table (it is located). (省略了 "It is" 和 "located")
- You should tell him, but you don't have to. (省略了 "tell him")
- **Ready** for the trip? (省略了主语 "Are you")
- **Given** a choice, which would you pick? (省略了主语和系动词 "If you are" 在状语从句中)

※ Cats, for instance, would be greatly helped; no running fights with large, fierce rats or tussles with grown rabbits -- just a bite and no more effort needed.

> Cats, for instance, would be greatly helped **if they manufactured poison**. 课文补全

『 **running** adj.lasting a long time; continuous 持久的，长时间的 』

- For years he had fought a **running battle** with the authorities over the land.
- He also began a **running** feud with Dean Acheson. 他也开始和艾奇逊院长发生接连不断的争执。
- He said drought had led to severe crop failure for the second year **running**. 他说干旱已连续两年造成严重农作物歉收。

『 **tussles with ...** 与...扭打，搏斗 a fight using a lot of energy, in which two people get hold of each other and struggle 扭打，搏斗 』

- She had a brief **tussle with** her conscience before telling the whole story.
- They began to **tussle with** each other for the coin. 他们为争夺硬币扭打起来。
- The referee booked him for a **tussle with** the goalie . 他和守门员拉扯，因而被裁判记名警告。

※ In fact, it would be an assistance to all carnivores though it would be a two-edged weapon when they fought each other.

> In fact, it would be an assistance to all carnivores ↔ In fact, it wouldbe an assistance to all carnivores **if they manufactured poison**. 补全课文

『 **two-edged weapon / sword** 双刃剑 』

- As is so often pointed out, knowledge is **a two-edged weapon** which can be used equally for good or evil.
- Mint forex reserve is **a two-edged weapon**, and it causes broad attention from the society. 外汇储备是把双刃剑，如此庞大的数字引起了社会的广泛关注。
- Technology is **a two-edged sword**. 技术是一把双刃剑。

two-edged weapon/sword 双刃剑 (n.)	Social media can be a **two-edged sword**, offering connection but also distraction. 社交媒体可能是一把双刃剑，既提供了联系，也会分散注意力。
double-edged weapon/sword 双刃剑 (n.)	The new policy is a **double-edged weapon**; it boosts profits but damages the environment. 这项新政策是一把双刃剑；它提高了利润，但破坏了环境。

『 **when they fought each other** 当它们互相搏斗时（when从句充当条件状语） 』

- ... though it would be a two-edged weapon **if they fought each other**. 课文替换
- How can I explain it to you **when** you won't listen?
- **When** I reverse the car, it makes a funny noise.

fight (with) sb. 与...作战	Two guys were **fighting (with) each other** in the street.

※ But, of the vertebrates, unpredictable Nature selected only snakes (and one lizard).

『 **of** prep. used when comparing related things （用于比较时）在……中 』

- I'm surprised that you **of** all people think that.
- A flat tyre today **of** all days what bad luck!
- He's the best looking **of** the three brothers.

※ One wonders also why Nature, with some snakes, concocted poison of such extreme potency.

『 **concoct** v.to produce sth. unusual by mixing things in a new way, esp. a drink or meal 调制 』

- The soup was **concocted from** up to a dozen different kinds of fish.
- What was the most unusual fragrance or flavor you've had to **concoct**? 你配制的最奇怪的香水或者香味是什么?
- But I'm going to need your help to **concoct** a story that will help me save face! 但你得帮我编造个故事，好给我留点脸面!
- From within, you have chosen to **concoct** a multitude of excuses and a barrier of fear. 从你选择地炮制了许多借口和障碍恐惧。

『 **potency** the strength of sth., esp. a drug, on your mind or body 效力，强度 』

- Improper storage may decrease the **potency of the drug.**
- The Numbers indicate the **potency** of the ingredient used. 数字是用来表示所用成份的效力的。
- Perhaps his **potency** as a lover also had a physical explanation. 可能是他的性能力强大，也可能有其他体质解释。

观点 (笔记最后修改于:2025-12-08 08:38:49) 3

※ In the conversion of saliva into poison, one might suppose that a fixed process took place.

『 **In** 在将...转化为...的过程中（介词 in 表时间） 』

- **In** the organization of industrial life the influence of the factory upon the physiological and mental state of the workers has been completely neglected.
- He walked two hundred and sixty miles **in** eight days. 他在八天里走了二百六十英里。
- The economy was **in** trouble. 经济陷于困境。

『 **the conversion of ... into ...** 转化 ... 名词短语与动词搭配介词相同 』

- the **conversion of** a barn **into** a house 转变用途
- the **conversion of** pounds **into** dollars 兑换
- In the **conversion of** saliva **into** poison 在...转换过程中

『 **take place** v.sth. happens that is planned or arranged（计划之中的事情）发生 』

- I don't think it will **take place**. 我想那种事是不可能发生的。
- Where is the meeting **taking place**?
- The wedding will **take place at St. Andrew's church**.

※ It did not; some snakes manufactured a poison different in every respect from that of others, as different as arsenic is from strychnine, and having different effects.

『 **be different from ...** 与...不同 』

- His world **seemed** so **different from** mine. 他的生活圈子与我的似乎是那么的不同。
- London **was different from** most European capitals. 伦敦与大多数的欧洲首都城市不同。
- The new methods **are radically different from** the old. 新的方法迥然不同于旧的方法。
- Her background **is markedly different from** her husband's. 她的背景和她丈夫的截然不同。

『 **in every respect / aspect / way** 在每个方面 』

- The situation is **different in every respect** from last year.
- The two approaches are similar **in many aspects**.

in every respect 在每个方面；完全地	The new edition of the textbook is an improvement on the last one **in every respect**. 这本新版教科书在每个方面都比上一版有所改进。
in every aspect 在每个方面；在各个层面	She is a truly professional athlete, dedicated to excellence **in every aspect** of her training. 她是一名真正的专业运动员，致力于在训练的各个方面追求卓越。

in every way 在每个方面；用所有方法	We tried to support them **in every way** possible after they lost their home. 我们尝试用所有可能的方法在各个方面支持他们，在他们失去家园之后。

『 **that of ...** （代指前文的同类名词）...的那个 』

- His **function** is analogous to **that of a judge**, ...
- The plotline is similar to **that of** many other movies. 该主要情节与其他众多电影的主要情节相似。
- Modern music is often considered inferior to **that of** the past. 现代音乐常被认为不如过去的。

『 **as different as A is from B** 就像 A 与 B 不同一样（用来补充说明不同程度） 』

> Chinese culture is different in every respect from that of America, **as different as** the giant panda **is from** the bald eagle. 中国文化在各个方面都与美国文化不同，就像大熊猫与白头鹰不同一样

※ One poison acts on the nerves, the other on the blood. 独立主格

『 **act on ...** 对...有效；作用于... (act v.to have an effect or use 有某种效果或作用) 』

- Alcohol **acts on the brain**.
- Disinfectants **act on bacteria** in two main ways.

act as ... 作为...而发挥效果；充当...	Later it was found that there was a type of mosquito which **acted as** the carrier of this disease and passed it on to the rabbits.

『 **the other (acting) on the blood** 另一个作用于血液（独立主格） 』

- One poison acts on the nerves, the other (acting) on the blood.

分析蛇毒（详述两种毒液） (笔记最后修改于:2025-12-08 09:55:33) 5

※ The makers of the nerve poison include the mambas and the cobras and their venom is called neurotoxic.

『 **be called / known as** 被称做、称为 』

- The coastal town **is called** Seaside, due to its location right by the ocean. 这个沿海小镇被称为海边镇，因为它就在海边。
- The largest galaxy in the cluster **is known as** the Andromeda Galaxy. 星系团中最大的星系被称为仙女座星系。

be referred to as ... 被称为...；被提及为... (强调提及或指代的方式)	In legal documents, the suspect **is referred to as** 'Party A'. 在法律文件中，嫌疑人被称为“甲方”。
be addressed as ... 被称为/称呼为... (强调称呼方式，常用于人)	In formal settings, the professor should **be addressed as** 'Dr. Smith'. 在正式场合，这位教授应该被称为“史密斯博士”。

※ Vipers (adders) and rattlesnakes manufacture the blood poison, which is known as haemolytic.

『**被称为是...**』

- The terrible secret **is called** 'a skeleton in the cupboard '.
- Because of this, they **were known as** 'prize-fighters'.
- People who work in offices **are** frequently **referred to** as 'white collar workers' for the simple reason that they usually wear a collar and tie to go to work.
- The president should **be addressed as** 'Mr. President'.

※ Both poisons are unpleasant, but by far the more unpleasant is the blood poison. 读出来有押韵效果

『**by far** (used with comparative or superlative adjectives or adverbs) by a great amount...得多（修饰比较级或最高级）』

- The last of these reasons is **by far** the most important.
- The second half of his voyage was **by far** the more dangerous part, during which he sailed round the treacherous Cape Horn.

> **Both** books **are** interesting, **but by far the more** interesting **is** 'Harry Potter'. 两个东西都...，但是更...的多得是...

※ It is said that the nerve poison is the more primitive of the two, that the blood poison is, so to speak, a newer product from an improved formula.

『**so to speak** 好像，仿佛，可以说是』

- He is, **so to speak / as it were,** a walking dictionary.
- The Han nationality and the minority nationalities are all, **so to speak / as it were,** members of the same family.

> Reading is thought to be a kind of conversation between the reader and the text. The reader puts questions, **as it were**, to the text and gets answers. In the light of these he puts further questions, and so on. 六级阅读

so to speak = as it were	• They will be able, **as it were,** to see and hear us in action. • They can never, **as it were,** lead independent lives, or 'rule the world' by making decisions of their own. • He gets the solid shape, **as it were,** inside his head—he thinks of it, whatever its size, as if he were holding it completely enclosed in the hollow of his hand.

『 **formula** n.a list of the substances used to make a medicine, fuel, drink etc, showing the amounts of each substance that should be used 配方，处方 』

- Our products are handmade from traditional **formulas**.
- The **formulas** for the drinks are closely guarded secrets.

※ Be that as it may, the nerve poison does its business with man far more quickly than the blood poison.

『 **Be that as it may** used to mean that you accept that a piece of information is true but it does not change your opinion of the subject you are discussing = despite that 尽管如此（让步状语倒装） 』

- **Be that as it may**, our expenditure is bound to increase.
- "I'm tired." "**Be that as it may**, you have to do some work."
- **Be that as it may**, we do not trust him anyway. 尽管如此，我们还是不信任他。
- The report indicates sales are down this quarter; **be that as it may**, we should still invest in marketing next year. 报告显示本季度销售额有所下降；尽管如此，我们明年仍应投资于营销。
- **Come what may**, we'll always stand by your side.
- **Come wind or rain**, I will go.

However that may be 尽管如此；无论情况如何	The forecast predicts heavy snow; however that may be, the concert will proceed as scheduled. 天气预报预测有大雪；无论情况如何，音乐会将按计划进行。
Despite that 尽管如此；虽然那样	The training was difficult and intense. Despite that, she managed to finish the marathon in record time. 训练既困难又紧张。尽管如此，她还是设法以创纪录的时间跑完了马拉松。
Come what may 无论发生什么；不管有什么后果 (强调决心)	**Come what may**, we are determined to complete this project on time. 无论发生什么，我们都决心按时完成这个项目。
Whatever may happen 无论可能发生什么	Whatever may happen, the staff has been instructed to keep the office running as usual. 无论可能发生什么，员工都接到指示要让办公室照常运转。
Come wind or rain 无论刮风下雨；风雨无阻 (强调不受天气影响)	The market stalls are always set up at dawn, come wind or rain. 集市摊位总是风雨无阻，在黎明时分搭建起来。

『 **do business with ...** 做生意；（派生、比喻）发挥效力 』

- I was fascinated by the different people who **did business with** me.
- You will stand to lose if you **do business with** him. 跟他作生意你是要吃亏的。
- I'd rather not **do business with** them. 我宁愿不和他们做生意了。

※ This, however, means nothing.

『**mean nothing** be not important 不重要』

- Time **meant nothing** to me while I was travelling.
- Your words **mean nothing**. 你的语言毫无意义。
- All the successes and triumphs they achieved **mean nothing** today. 他们所取得的成功和胜利在今日也毫无意义。

※ Snakes did not acquire their poison for use against man but for use against prey such as rats and mice, and the effects on these of viperine poison is almost immediate.

『**the effect / influence / impact of ... on / upon ...** ...对...的效果/影响』

- In the organization of industrial life **the influence of** the factory **upon** the physiological and mental state of the workers has been completely neglected.

the effect of ... on/upon ... ... 对...的效果/影响 (n.)	A recent study examined **the effect of** sleep deprivation **on** cognitive performance. 最近的一项研究检验了睡眠不足对认知能力的影响。
the influence of ... on/upon ... ...对...的影响力/影响 (n.)	The exhibition explores **the influence of** African art **on** European modernism. 这次展览探索了非洲艺术对欧洲现代主义的影响。
the impact of ... on/upon ... ...对...的冲击/影响 (n. 强调强烈或深远的影响)	The government is assessing t**he impact of** the new trade tariffs **on** local businesses. 政府正在评估新贸易关税对当地企业的影响。



Go-to

必选的；首选的；老地方

Idioms